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BACKGROUND GUIDE

UNGA – DISEC

Agenda : Addressing the Securitization of the Arctic and its Implications for Global Disarmament and Geopolitical Stability.



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UNGA – DISEC

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UNGA – DISEC

1. INTRODUCTION TO THE COMMITTEE (DISEC)

The Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC) is one of the six main committees of the United Nations General Assembly. It deals with disarmament, global challenges, and threats to peace that affect the international community. DISEC considers all disarmament and international security matters within the scope of the UN Charter, seeking to reduce and eventually eliminate weapons of mass destruction, address conventional arms challenges, and produce draft resolutions for adoption by the General Assembly.

For this session, the committee will deliberate on one of the most critical geopolitical frontiers of the 21st century the Arctic region which has undergone rapid transformation from a zone of scientific cooperation and environmental concern into a theater of great-power competition, military posturing, and resource rivalry. The committee's mandate is to produce forward-looking frameworks that address the securitization of the Arctic while advancing the broader goals of global disarmament and geopolitical stability.

Delegates are expected to critically examine the interplay between climate change, territorial sovereignty, military buildup, indigenous rights, and international law, and to propose multilateral solutions that can realistically de-escalate tensions in the High North.

DISEC sessions follow three distinctive stages:

- General Debate: Member states deliver opening position statements on the agenda item
- Thematic Discussions: Focused deliberations on specific sub-issues, working paper negotiations, and bloc consultations
- Action on Drafts: Formal introduction, amendment, and voting on draft resolutions

Delegates are expected to arrive with a thorough understanding of their country's official position on Arctic security and disarmament, to engage constructively with opposing blocs, and to negotiate resolutions that can attract broad consensus across the 193 UN Member States.

2. BACKGROUND AND CONTEXT

The Arctic region encompassing the Arctic Ocean, adjacent seas, and the territories of eight sovereign states (Canada, Denmark/Greenland, Finland, Iceland, Norway, Russia, Sweden, and the United States) was long regarded as a peripheral zone of global affairs. However, it has become a fulcrum of international geopolitics for three primary reasons:

- **CLIMATE CHANGE AND RESOURCE ACCESSIBILITY:** The Arctic is warming nearly four times faster than the global average. Melting sea ice has unlocked vast quantities of previously inaccessible natural resources. The U.S. Geological Survey estimates the Arctic holds approximately 13% of the world's undiscovered oil and 30% of its undiscovered natural gas. Additionally, new maritime routes notably the Northern Sea Route (NSR) and the Northwest Passage have become increasingly viable, cutting shipping distances between Europe and Asia by up to 40% compared to routes through the Suez Canal.
- **STRATEGIC MILITARY VALUE:** The Arctic is the shortest corridor between the two largest nuclear powers – the United States and Russia. Nuclear-armed submarines of both countries regularly transit Arctic waters. Russia has stationed nuclear warhead facilities on the Kola Peninsula, just across the border from Norway. NATO's expansion with Finland and Sweden (both now full NATO members as of 2023-2024) has dramatically altered the military geography of the High North.
- **GREAT POWER COMPETITION:** Russia, the United States, and China all have active Arctic strategies. Russia holds the largest Arctic territory and the most developed military presence in the region. China, a non-Arctic state, declared itself a 'near-Arctic state' in 2018 and has pursued a 'Polar Silk Road' vision tied to its Belt and Road Initiative. Defense spending on Arctic-specific capabilities by Arctic nations surged by more than 65% between 2018 and 2025 (SIPRI Yearbook 2025).

3. KEY DEFINITIONS

Delegates must be familiar with the following terms and concepts:

SECURITIZATION: A political process by which issues that are not traditionally considered security matters are reframed as existential threats requiring extraordinary political and military responses. In the Arctic context, resources, shipping routes, and environmental governance are being securitized by major powers.

DEMILITARIZATION: The process of removing military forces, weapons, and installations from a territory or region. The Antarctic Treaty (1959) is the most cited model of successful demilitarization of a polar region.

NUCLEAR WEAPON-FREE ZONE (NWFZ): A geographical area where states commit through a legally binding treaty to the total absence of nuclear weapons. NWFZs currently exist in Latin America (Treaty of Tlatelolco), the South Pacific (Treaty of Rarotonga), Southeast Asia (Treaty of Bangkok), Africa (Treaty of Pelindaba), and Central Asia (Treaty of Semipalatinsk). No such zone exists in the Arctic.

CONFIDENCE-BUILDING MEASURES (CBMs): Political and military actions taken to reduce tensions and build trust between potentially hostile parties. Examples include advance notifications of military exercises, information exchanges, and observer missions.

ARCTIC COUNCIL: The leading intergovernmental forum for promoting cooperation in the Arctic region, founded in 1996 via the Ottawa Declaration. It comprises the eight Arctic states and six Permanent Participant organizations representing indigenous peoples. It is explicitly barred from addressing military security issues.

UNCLOS (UN Convention on the Law of the Sea, 1982): The primary legal framework governing maritime boundaries, including in the Arctic. Key articles include Article 76 (extended continental shelf claims up to 350 nautical miles), Article 19 (innocent passage), and Article 234 (special provisions for ice-covered waters).

NORTHERN SEA ROUTE (NSR): A shipping lane along the Russian Arctic coast connecting the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans. Russia claims sovereign control over it; most Western nations contest this under UNCLOS.

NORTHWEST PASSAGE: A maritime route through the Canadian Arctic Archipelago. Canada claims it as internal waters; the United States and other nations treat it as an international strait.

KOLA PENINSULA: A strategically vital Russian peninsula near the border with Norway that hosts the Russian Northern Fleet's nuclear submarine base, making it one of the most heavily militarized areas in the Arctic.

4. HISTORICAL BACKGROUND

4.1 Cold War Era : The Arctic as Nuclear Battleground

During the Cold War (1947–1991), the Arctic was fundamentally a military theater. Both the United States and the Soviet Union stationed nuclear-armed submarines beneath Arctic ice, exploiting the region's acoustically unique environment for strategic deterrence. The Distant Early Warning (DEW) Line was established across Arctic North America to detect Soviet bombers, and both superpowers maintained extensive air and naval bases throughout the High North. The region hosted some of the most dangerous nuclear confrontations of the Cold War era, with submarine encounters and near-misses that have only recently been declassified.

4.2 The Post–Cold War 'Arctic Exceptionalism' Period (1991–2007)

After the Soviet Union's collapse, the Arctic entered a period sometimes called 'Arctic Exceptionalism' — a paradigm of cooperation amid global competition. The Arctic Environmental Protection Strategy (AEPS, 1991) and subsequently the Arctic Council (1996) institutionalized a governance model focused on environmental protection, sustainable development, and indigenous peoples' rights. Military issues were deliberately excluded from the Arctic Council's mandate. This era was characterized by the 'Low Tension, High Cooperation' doctrine.

The Svalbard Treaty (1920), which granted Norway sovereignty over the Svalbard Archipelago while guaranteeing other signatory nations equal rights to engage in commercial activities and prohibiting military fortifications, served as a partial precedent for demilitarization in the Arctic.

Gorbachev's 1987 Murmansk Speech was a landmark moment, in which he proposed transforming the Arctic into a 'Zone of Peace' through nuclear-weapon-free zone proposals, restrictions on naval activities, and enhanced scientific cooperation a vision that has regained relevance today.

4.3 The Inflection Point : Russia's 2007 Flag Planting and Rising Competition

In August 2007, a Russian submarine planted the Russian flag on the seabed of the North Pole, symbolizing Moscow's assertive territorial ambitions. This act, combined with Russia's expansive continental shelf claims to the UN Commission on the Limits of the Continental Shelf (CLCS), marked the beginning of intensified geopolitical competition. Canada, Denmark, Norway, and the United States subsequently filed their own extended continental shelf submissions, creating overlapping and contested claims over vast areas of the Arctic Ocean seabed.

5. CURRENT STATE OF AFFAIRS (2022–2026)

5.1 The Ukraine War Turning Point

Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in February 2022 fundamentally restructured Arctic geopolitics. The seven remaining Arctic Council members (Canada, Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, Sweden, and the United States) suspended all Arctic Council activities involving Russia in March 2022 the first major interruption in the body's 26-year history. This suspension left the world's most critical environmental and geopolitical region without a multilateral governance mechanism at the precise moment it needed one most.

Since February 2022, Russia has reframed its Arctic policy from development-focused to security-focused. The Kremlin has increased military exercises, deployed advanced air defense systems, expanded Arctic-based military units, and deepened its reliance on the NSR as both an economic lifeline (given Western sanctions) and a strategic instrument.

5.2 The Ukraine War Turning Point

Finland joined NATO in April 2023, and Sweden in March 2024. This expansion transformed the Baltic Sea into a near-NATO lake and added two highly capable militaries with sophisticated Arctic expertise to the alliance. Norway which shares a 196-kilometer border with Russia took over the Arctic Council chairship from Russia in May 2023 and has worked to partially resume working group cooperation.

NATO has substantially increased its Arctic exercises and established new command structures. However, there remains no unified NATO Arctic strategy. The Belfer Center (Harvard) notes that the absence of a cohesive NATO Arctic strategy leaves gaps in deterrence planning that Russia has been actively exploiting through a blended toolkit of dual-use infrastructure, diplomatic posturing, and outright military expansion.

5.3 The Russia-China Arctic Axis

Following the Ukraine invasion and subsequent Western sanctions, Russia has deepened its Arctic partnership with China. This includes joint military exercises in the Bering Sea and Arctic Ocean, Chinese investment in Russian LNG projects (Yamal LNG and Arctic LNG-2), and cooperation on NSR shipping infrastructure. However, the depth of this partnership remains uncertain — analysts debate whether Sino-Russian Arctic cooperation represents a genuine strategic axis or is primarily symbolic deterrence posturing against the United States and NATO.

China's official Arctic White Paper (2018) emphasizes peaceful use, scientific research, and freedom of navigation. However, the PLA has been quietly developing capabilities that could extend to Arctic operations, including advanced icebreakers and research vessels that dual-function for intelligence gathering.

6. THE CLIMATE-SECURITY NEXUS

Climate change and Arctic securitization are deeply intertwined. As The Arctic Institute (2026) explains, while climate change alters what is possible in the Arctic, it does not by itself explain why states are more anxious and competitive. Instead, environmental change acts as an amplifier, magnifying existing geopolitical tensions.

Key climate-security linkages include:

- **RESOURCE ACCESS:** Melting permafrost and receding sea ice are opening previously inaccessible oil, gas, and mineral deposits. The Arctic already supplies roughly 10% of global oil and 25% of global natural gas production (WWF). The United States Geological Survey estimates 22% of Earth's undiscovered oil and gas reserves lie in the Arctic.
- **SHIPPING ROUTES:** The Northern Sea Route (NSR) reduces Europe-Asia shipping distances by 40% compared to the Suez Canal. Climate change is making the NSR viable for longer seasons, intensifying its strategic value. Russia views the NSR as sovereign territory; the U.S. contests this designation under UNCLOS.
- **DUAL-USE INFRASTRUCTURE:** Infrastructure built for civilian commercial purposes (icebreakers, ports, radar stations) can rapidly be converted to military use. This blurs the line between development and defense, increasing the risk of misperception.
- **INDIGENOUS PEOPLES' RIGHTS:** Climate change is destroying Arctic indigenous communities' traditional ways of life. Reindeer herding Nenets people in Russia face disrupted migratory routes from oil and gas infrastructure. In Alaska and Canada, coastal communities face existential threats from permafrost thaw and sea level rise. Indigenous peoples' rights and climate justice must be central to any sustainable Arctic governance framework.

7. KEY ACTORS AND THEIR POSITIONS

7.1 Russia

Russia is the largest Arctic state, possessing 53% of the Arctic coastline. Moscow's Arctic strategy has pivoted since 2022 toward military dominance and deterrence. Key actions include: reopening Soviet-era military bases along the Arctic coast; deploying the world's largest nuclear-powered icebreaker fleet; expanding the Northern Fleet's nuclear submarine capabilities; and building advanced S-400 air defense systems in the High North. Russia frames these as defensive responses to NATO expansion. Russia has blocked resumption of full Arctic Council activities.

7.2 United States

The United States identifies Russia as an acute threat and China as its pacing threat in the Arctic. The 2024 DoD Arctic Strategy identified China-Russia collaboration as the primary long-term threat to U.S. interests. The U.S. has invested in icebreaker construction (historically lagging behind Russia), increased Arctic military exercises, and leveraged NATO alliances to balance Russian and Chinese influence. The U.S. has NOT ratified UNCLOS a significant limitation on its ability to make or contest continental shelf claims.

7.3 China

China is an Arctic observer state, not a full member of the Arctic Council. Despite this, Beijing has declared itself a 'near-Arctic state' and published a comprehensive Arctic Policy (2018). China's Arctic interests center on: (1) Polar Silk Road shipping lanes; (2) energy resources via partnerships with Russia (Yamal LNG); (3) scientific research (Yellow River Station on Svalbard); and (4) strategic positioning. The 14th Five-Year Plan explicitly includes the Arctic as a priority region. China emphasizes 'peaceful use' while Western analysts note increasing dual-use concerns.

7.3 Nordic/NATO Arctic States (Norway, Denmark/Greenland, Iceland, Canada, Finland, Sweden)

These states are caught between seeking continued Arctic cooperation and upholding collective defense commitments. Norway has been the most pragmatic, maintaining bilateral dialogue with Russia on practical Arctic matters while serving as NATO's frontline Arctic state. Canada has aggressive continental shelf claims and has been vocal on indigenous rights and the status of the Northwest Passage. Denmark/Greenland occupies a strategically pivotal position, with Greenland's critical minerals attracting enormous U.S. strategic interest including President Trump's controversial 2019 and 2025 proposals to purchase Greenland.

7.5 Indigenous Peoples' Organizations

Six indigenous organizations hold Permanent Participant status in the Arctic Council: Aleut International Association, Arctic Athabaskan Council, Gwich'in Council International, Inuit Circumpolar Council (ICC), Russian Association of Indigenous Peoples of the North (RAIPON), and Sámi Council. The ICC's 1983 Declaration on a Nuclear Free Arctic remains a landmark statement of indigenous peoples' opposition to Arctic militarization. These groups argue that Arctic people and communities can only be strong and safe in the absence of military activity, including nuclear weapons.

8. EXISTING LEGAL AND INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK

The current governance of the Arctic is characterized by a patchwork of legal instruments, none of which comprehensively address military security or disarmament:

- **UNCLOS (1982):** The foundational legal framework governing maritime boundaries, resource rights, and navigational freedoms in the Arctic Ocean. Key provisions: Article 76 (continental shelf up to 350 nm), Article 234 (ice-covered waters), Article 19 (innocent passage). Note: The U.S. has not ratified UNCLOS.
- **ARCTIC COUNCIL (1996, Ottawa Declaration):** The primary intergovernmental forum for Arctic cooperation. Comprises 8 Arctic states and 6 indigenous organizations as Permanent Participants. Critical limitation: explicitly excludes military security from its mandate. Partially paralyzed since Russia's 2022 Ukraine invasion.
- **SVALBARD TREATY (1920):** Grants Norway sovereignty over Svalbard while guaranteeing equal access to all 46 signatory nations for peaceful commercial activities. Prohibits military installations. Often cited as a partial model for Arctic demilitarization.
- **ANTARCTIC TREATY (1959):** Demilitarizes Antarctica entirely and establishes it as a global commons for scientific research. Frequently proposed as a model for an Arctic Treaty, though significant differences exist: unlike Antarctica, the Arctic Ocean borders sovereign states with overlapping territorial claims.



- **NPT (Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, 1968)**: Obliges nuclear states not to transfer nuclear weapons and non-nuclear states not to acquire them. Relevant but does not specifically address nuclear-armed submarines in Arctic waters.
- **TPNW (Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons, 2017, entered into force 2021)**: Bans use, possession, testing, and transfer of nuclear weapons. No Arctic or major nuclear state has ratified it. Russia has consistently voted against UNGA resolutions welcoming the TPNW.
- **ILULISSAT DECLARATION (2008)**: Issued by the five Arctic coastal states (Canada, Denmark, Norway, Russia, USA), affirming commitment to resolving overlapping territorial claims through UNCLOS rather than conflict. A significant confidence-building measure, though non-binding.
- **INUIT CIRCUMPOLAR COUNCIL'S 1983 DECLARATION ON A NUCLEAR-FREE ARCTIC**: A landmark civil society instrument calling for the Arctic to be free of nuclear weapons, the foundation for Arctic NWFZ advocacy..



9. CORE ISSUES FOR DEBATE

The following are the central tensions and debates this committee must grapple with:

ISSUE 1 : GOVERNANCE GAP

The Arctic Council cannot discuss military security, yet the Arctic's most pressing threats are military in nature. Is there a need for a new security body? How can states maintain practical cooperation (on climate, search and rescue, shipping safety) while managing military tensions?

ISSUE 2 : NUCLEAR WEAPONS IN ARCTIC WATERS

U.S. and Russian ballistic missile submarines (SSBNs) regularly patrol Arctic waters. These submarines carry enough firepower to end human civilization. No binding treaty governs their presence in the Arctic. An Arctic NWFZ has been proposed by Canadian Pugwash, the Inuit Circumpolar Council, and numerous academics, but faces profound challenges: neither Russia nor the U.S. would agree to denuclearize their most survivable second-strike capability.

ISSUE 3 : OVERLAPPING TERRITORIAL CLAIMS

Russia, Canada, Denmark/Greenland, and Norway all have overlapping extended continental shelf claims around the Lomonosov Ridge and the central Arctic Ocean. These are being adjudicated through UNCLOS/CLCS processes, but the U.S. — not a UNCLOS signatory — has its own claims. Unresolved maritime boundaries create flashpoints for conflict.

ISSUE 4 : DUAL-USE INFRASTRUCTURE

Russia has built what the Jamestown Foundation (2026) calls a 'blended toolkit' of military and civilian Arctic assets. Icebreakers, deep-sea fiber optic cables, and weather stations serve both economic and military purposes. This ambiguity makes verification of any demilitarization agreement extremely challenging.

ISSUE 5 : RUSSIA'S ISOLATION VS. ENGAGEMENT

Russia is a necessary party to any Arctic governance solution, yet it is currently an international pariah due to the Ukraine war. Should the committee advocate for conditional re-engagement of Russia in Arctic governance mechanisms? Under what conditions?

ISSUE 6 : CHINA'S ROLE

China is not an Arctic state, yet its economic and strategic interests in the region are enormous. The Georgetown Journal of International Affairs (2025) warns that China-Russia collaboration in the Arctic elevates the risk of miscalculation. How should non-Arctic states be governed within Arctic frameworks?

ISSUE 7 : INDIGENOUS RIGHTS AND MILITARIZATION

Arctic militarization directly impacts indigenous communities' lands and ways of life. The UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP) requires free, prior, and informed consent for actions affecting indigenous communities. How can this be reconciled with states' national security imperatives?

10. RELEVANT UN DOCUMENTS AND RESOLUTIONS

Delegates must be familiar with the following key documents:

- UNGA Resolution 1 (I) (1946): The United Nations' very first resolution, establishing the goal of eliminating atomic weapons and all weapons of mass destruction. Remains foundational to the global disarmament agenda.
- NPT Review Conferences: Periodic reviews of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty. The 2022 Review Conference failed to produce a consensus final document, largely due to disagreements over Russia's occupation of the Zaporizhzhia nuclear plant in Ukraine.
- UNGA Resolution A/RES/73/73 (2018): On 'Reducing Nuclear Danger', calls for step-by-step measures toward a nuclear-weapon-free world.
- UNGA Resolution A/RES/65/68 (2010) and subsequent resolutions on 'Women, disarmament, non-proliferation and arms control', relevant to inclusive governance frameworks.
- UN Secretary-General's Agenda for Disarmament (2018): 'Securing our Common Future', outlines a roadmap for global disarmament across nuclear, conventional, and emerging weapons domains.



- UNSC Resolution 1887 (2009): On nuclear non-proliferation and disarmament; stressed the importance of fully implementing UNSC Resolution 1540.
- UNSC Resolution 1540 (2004): Obliges all states to refrain from supporting non-state actors seeking to develop, acquire, or use WMDs.
- UNDRIP (UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples, 2007): Establishes the right of indigenous peoples to free, prior, and informed consent for decisions affecting their lands and communities. Key articles: 19 and 32.
- UNGA Resolution on Comprehensive Test Ban Treaty (CTBT): UNSC Resolution 2310 (2016): Commemorated the 20th anniversary of the CTBT opening for signature; called upon all remaining states to ratify.
- The Arctic Council's Search and Rescue Agreement (2011), Marine Oil Pollution Preparedness and Response Agreement (2013), and Scientific Cooperation Agreement (2017): Three binding Arctic Council agreements that demonstrate functional cooperation is possible even amid political tensions.

11. POSSIBLE SOLUTIONS AND POLICY DIRECTIONS

Delegates should consider the following policy approaches and their feasibility:

SOLUTION 1: ARCTIC NUCLEAR WEAPON-FREE ZONE (ANWFZ)

Multiple models have been proposed (Pugwash Canada, PNND, UNIDIR):

- Model A (Antarctic Treaty Model): Full demilitarization of the entire Arctic zone, requiring all Arctic states, including Russia and the U.S., to withdraw nuclear weapons from the region. Highly ambitious; extremely unlikely given current tensions.
- Model B (Standard NWFZ Model): Treaty negotiated by non-nuclear Arctic states (Canada, Denmark, Iceland, Norway) prohibiting nuclear weapons on their territories, with protocols for NWS not to station or threaten use against these states. More feasible as a starting point.
- Model C (Pugwash Canada's Incremental Approach): Begin with a limited NWFZ prohibiting nuclear weapon transit through the Northwest Passage, to be expanded incrementally. Designed to lock in non-nuclear states first, then expand the zone.

SOLUTION 2: REFORMED OR NEW ARCTIC GOVERNANCE BODY

The Georgetown Journal of International Affairs (2025) proposes a new governance organization modeled on the UN Security Council, with legal standing to address both soft and hard security issues. This body would give Russia and the U.S. veto power (ensuring their participation) while granting rotational veto to the six remaining Arctic states and institutionalizing indigenous peoples' representation.

SOLUTION 3: CONFIDENCE-BUILDING MEASURES (CBMs)

Short of formal treaties, incremental CBMs can build trust:

- Mandatory notification of Arctic military exercises
- Establishment of direct hotlines between Arctic command centers
- Regular ministerial-level Arctic Security Dialogue (separate from the Arctic Council)
- Observer access to military installations in agreed buffer zones



SOLUTION 4 : FUNCTIONAL SEPARATION (DECOUPLED COOPERATION)

Maintain Arctic Council cooperation on non-military domains (climate, environmental monitoring, shipping safety, SAR) while creating a separate security track. Norway's current chair ship demonstrates that partial resumption of cooperation is possible.

SOLUTION 5 : U.S. RATIFICATION OF UNCLOS

The U.S. is the only Arctic state not party to UNCLOS, which undermines the legal framework for territorial dispute resolution. U.S. ratification would strengthen the rules-based order in the Arctic.

SOLUTION 6 : SVALBARD-PLUS MODEL

Expand the Svalbard Treaty model to other contested Arctic zones, granting sovereignty to individual states while guaranteeing demilitarization and equal access for all signatories.

12. QUESTIONS A RESOLUTION MUST ANSWER (QARMAS)

The following questions must be substantively addressed in any resolution produced by this committee:

1. How should the international community address the institutional gap in Arctic security governance, given that the Arctic Council cannot deal with military issues?
2. What concrete steps can be taken to prevent an arms race in the Arctic, particularly regarding nuclear-armed submarines and dual-use military installations?
3. How should overlapping territorial claims in the Arctic be resolved, and what role should UNCLOS, or a reformed legal framework, play in this process?
4. Under what conditions, if any, should Russia be re-engaged in Arctic multilateral governance mechanisms, and how can cooperation on non-military issues be maintained without legitimizing actions that violate international law?
5. What role should non-Arctic states, especially China, be permitted to play in Arctic governance, and how can their economic interests be accommodated without compromising the security interests of Arctic states?
6. How can the rights and interests of Arctic indigenous peoples be protected and centered in any governance or security framework produced by this committee?
7. What verification mechanisms are feasible to ensure compliance with any demilitarization or confidence-building agreements in the Arctic, given the region's vast geography and the dual-use nature of most Arctic infrastructure?
8. How can the Arctic be governed in a way that allows climate research and environmental cooperation to continue, even as military tensions persist?
9. What is the path toward an Arctic Nuclear-Weapon-Free Zone, and what incremental measures can be taken in the near term to move toward that goal?
10. How can global disarmament norms be strengthened through Arctic-specific action, and what linkages should this committee draw between Arctic securitization and broader challenges to the NPT, TPNW, and the global non-proliferation regime?

13. FURTHER RESEARCH AND RECOMMENDED READING

Delegates are strongly encouraged to research the following materials before committee:

THINK TANKS & RESEARCH INSTITUTIONS:

- The Arctic Institute (thearcticinstitute.org): The most comprehensive English-language source on Arctic geopolitics, policy, and governance.
- Belfer Center for Science and International Affairs, Harvard University (belfercenter.org): Key publication: 'Arctic Security: Power Shifts and Transformational Change' (2026)
- Pugwash Canada (pugwashgroup.ca): Leading advocate for an Arctic NWFZ, with detailed technical proposals
- SIPRI Yearbook 2025 (sipri.org): Data on Arctic defense spending and nuclear capabilities
- Carnegie Endowment for International Peace (carnegieendowment.org): 'Global Energy Competition in the Arctic' (July 2025)
- Stockholm Centre for Eastern European Studies (SCEEUS): 'Sino-Russian Cooperation in the Arctic' (October 2024)
- Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS): Arctic Military Tracker
- Quincy Institute for Responsible Statecraft: 'Restraint and Diplomacy in Arctic Policy' (January 2026)

ACADEMIC JOURNALS:

- Georgetown Journal of International Affairs: 'The Future of Arctic Governance in a Fractured Geopolitical Landscape' (October 2025)
- Arctic Yearbook (arcticyearbook.com): Annual peer-reviewed publication on Arctic policy
- Marine Policy (ScienceDirect): 'On thin ice: The Arctic Council's uncertain future' (2024)
- Air University Strategic Studies Quarterly: 'The Arctic in the New Geopolitical Context'



GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS:

- China's Arctic Policy White Paper (2018): English text at english.www.gov.cn
- U.S. Department of Defense Arctic Strategy (2024)
- Russia's Arctic Strategy documents (TASS/Russian Government official releases)
- Norway's Arctic Council Chairship Program (2023-2025)

INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS:

- Arctic Council Official Website (arctic-council.org)
- UNIDIR (UN Institute for Disarmament Research) – 'Nuclear Weapon-Free Zones' report
- UN ODA (Office for Disarmament Affairs) – un.org/disarmament
- Basel Peace Office, Arctic NWFZ analysis (baselpeaceoffice.org)

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